the Bangladesh war clearly demonstrated that the Pakistanis could not risk fighting the Indians again. After 1972, the Pakistanis stopped challenging India for control of Kashmir. But they did not abandon the Kashmir cause. Rather, they reserved the right to fight for Kashmir later, when the strategic situation changed. As Zulfikar Ali Bhutto explained in the wake of the Bangladesh conflict: At present "I cannot go to war. Not in the next 5, 10 or 15 years." However, "if tomorrow the people of Kashmir start a freedom movement," Bhutto continued, "we will be with them. . . . We will fight if we want to fight. . . . This is an eternal position."[16]

By the late 1980s, Pakistan's strategic situation had in fact changed, enabling the Pakistanis once again to begin challenging the Kashmiri status quo. This change resulted from several factors. First, in 1989 an armed insurgency against Indian rule erupted in the territory of Jammu and Kashmir, killing large numbers of civilians and security personnel, and threatening to undermine Indian control of the region.[17] Second, the Afghan war offered a model that Pakistan could use to exploit the insurgency and defeat a stronger, occupying power in Kashmir. It also provided experienced military and intelligence personnel capable of executing such a strategy. In addition, the end of the war in Afghanistan freed large numbers of mujahideen from their battle with the Soviets, creating the possibility that these fighters could be redirected to wage jihad in Kashmir.[18] Third, Pakistani leaders believed that with the end of the Cold War, the world community might be more willing than it had been to address the Kashmir issue.[19]

But equally important as these factors was Pakistan's acquisition of a nuclear capacity, which would enable the Pakistanis to challenge territorial boundaries in Kashmir without fearing catastrophic Indian retaliation. Pakistani leaders openly acknowledge nuclear weapons' emboldening effect on their strategic calculations. Benazir Bhutto, who served her first term as Pakistani prime minister from 1988 to 1990, explains that Pakistan did not originally seek a nuclear capacity "for Kashmir-specific purposes." However, over time, the nuclear capacity's utility in Kashmir "came out" as a major factor in Pakistani strategic thinking. "Islamabad saw its capability as a deterrence to any future war with India [because] a conventional